Low-Cost & Community Resources

Last updated: November 1, 2026

These programs offer free or low-cost care for pets in and around Tompkins County. Most focus on wellness and prevention. Options for sick or injured pets are very limited, so if your pet is ill, contact a veterinarian as soon as possible.

Low-cost and free clinics

Street Dog Coalition – Ithaca

Free care for the pets of people experiencing homelessness.

- **When:** First Monday of every month, starting at 4:00pm
- **Where:** Salvation Army, 150 N. Albany St, Ithaca
- **How:** Walk-in, no appointment needed
- **Services:** Wellness exams, vaccines, microchips, parasite prevention, and limited treatment for minor problems such as skin or ear infections
- **Not offered:** Urgent or emergency care
- **Website:** thestreetdogcoalition.org/ithaca-ny

Southside Healthy Pet Clinic – Ithaca

Low-cost wellness care run by Cornell veterinary students, for families with low incomes.

- **When:** Second and fourth Wednesday of every month, 6:00pm–9:00pm
- **Where:** Southside Community Center, 305 S. Plain St, Ithaca
- **Cost:** $20 per pet, plus $10 for a microchip. Cash only.
- **How:** By appointment. Email southsidecornell@gmail.com, call (607) 873-2612, or message @SouthsidePetClinic on Facebook.
- **Services:** Physical exam, vaccines, SNAP testing, microchips. Heartworm, flea and tick prevention are included in the visit.
- **Bring one of these:** Medicaid, SSI/disability, EBT, W-2, pay stubs, food assistance, or other proof of public assistance

Shelter Outreach Services (SOS) – Spay/Neuter Clinics

Affordable, high-quality spay and neuter surgery for dogs and cats, through a mobile clinic that rotates around the region.

- **Cost:** Varies by surgery and add-on services
- **How:** Appointment required. Contact the location you want through the SOS website.
- **Services:** Spay/neuter surgery and core vaccines. Some locations offer more.

Location	Clinic days (subject to change)
Ithaca	Tuesdays
Cortland	Monday, Friday, Saturday
Binghamton	Monday and Thursday
Chemung	Sundays and rotating weekdays
Auburn	Wednesdays
Waterloo	Some Wednesdays, Fridays and Saturdays
Watkins Glen	Wednesdays
Waverly	Fridays

Maddie's® Shelter & Community Medicine – Community Wellness Clinics

Free wellness clinics run by Cornell students and faculty, for veterans, active-duty service members, and first responders.

- **When and where:** Dates and locations vary. Check the website or Facebook (@CUMSMP).
- **Services:** Core vaccines, microchips, flea/tick/heartworm prevention, deworming, basic skin and ear treatment, and limited other medications as needed
- **Website:** Maddie's® Shelter Medicine Program

SPCA of Tompkins County

We are not a veterinary clinic, but we may be able to help in some cases:

- **One-time surgery** for a pet already diagnosed by a veterinarian. There is a cost, set case by case.

- **Spay and neuter** and **TNR for community cats**
- **Free rabies clinics**

Learn more at spcaonline.com/vet-care or email info@spcaonline.com.

Outside the area

- **Spay Neuter Save Network** (Rome, PA): (570) 247-8383

Finding care online

- **PetHelpFinder.org**: search for affordable vet care and other pet help near you
- **Humane World for Animals**: help with vet care, pet food, and other costs
- **Veterinary Partner**: pet health information written by veterinarians

Getting your pet to an appointment

- **TCAT buses** allow pets in an enclosed pet carrier. Trained service animals can ride without a carrier. See TCAT's FAQ.
- **Ask your vet clinic.** Some clinics work with local transport services.
- **Uber** allows pets on rides (a fee may apply). Tell your driver about your pet when you book.
- **Lyft** allows pets with the driver's approval. Message your driver before pickup.
- **Pet sitters on Rover or Wag!** sometimes offer rides to appointments.
- **House call vets** come to you. See the **Emergency & Veterinary Care Directory**.

Help for you, too

Caring for a pet through a hard time is stressful. These services are here for people, too.

Service	What it offers	Contact
2-1-1 Tompkins	Free, confidential help finding housing, food, transportation, health care and other local services. Open 24/7, with interpreters available.	Dial 2-1-1 or (877) 211-8667

Service	What it offers	Contact
Tompkins County Mental Health	Walk-in intake, no appointment needed, for anyone who lives or works in Tompkins County. Mon, Tue and Thu 8:30am–2:00pm; Wed 10:30am–3:00pm. 201 E. Green St, Ithaca.	(607) 274-6200
The Advocacy Center	24-hour hotline for domestic violence and sexual abuse, with emotional support, a confidential safe house, and support at court, police and medical appointments.	(607) 277-5000
REACH Medical	Primary care and behavioral health for people experiencing homelessness or drug use.	(607) 273-7000

In crisis or thinking about suicide? Call or text 988 to reach a trained counselor.